CITED RECOMMENDED MENTIONED ABSENT

The four labels every AI answer receives for each brand

100X ENGINEERING | MANUAL MVP SUBMISSION

AI Visibility Audit

Is our brand in the AI answer? A 21-day manual MVP to test whether B2B marketing leads in Singapore and Southeast Asia (SEA) will trust and pay for a repeatable measure of their brand's presence in AI answers.

Krishna Nellutla | 3 October 2026 to 23 October 2026 | Data as of 10 October 2026

SNAPSHOT

Day 8	1	7	8 / 1 / 0
of 21	cards done (5 in progress)	days behind plan	survey / interviews / audits

CURRENT VERDICT

Continue validation. Do not build a product yet. The problem is plausible and the hypothesis is testable. Early survey responses and one expert interview support that the problem is real, and the expert's written advice sharpened the first segment and the pilot. But the interviewee is not a target-segment buyer, no audits are logged, the observation is still a composite, and nothing yet shows that anyone in the target segment will pay.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

Nothing here is presented as collected evidence unless it says so. Two items are labelled exceptions: the draft composite observation in section 1, and the five synthetic answer-labelling pairs used to test the labeller. Survey responses arrive live from the Google Form and are counted as they come; interviews and audits are counted as they are logged, and zero is shown as zero.

CONTENTS

Submission at a glance . . . 2
1 Observation . . . 2
2 Hypothesis . . . 3
3 Discovery document . . . 4
4 21-day manual MVP plan . . . 10
5 Published tracker link . . . 13
6 Validation log . . . 13
Golden set and grading . . . 17
7 Input, process, output card . . . 17
8 Verdict . . . 18

DELIVERABLES

Submission at a glance

Eight deliverables, with the honest status of each as of 10 October 2026.

DELIVERABLE	STATUS	WHERE IT STANDS
Observation	**Done**	Draft composite written from my notes on generative engine optimisation (GEO: making content more likely to be cited in AI answers). Not a real person's account. To be replaced after three conversations.
Hypothesis	**Done**	Numeric and falsifiable. First segment narrowed to B2B payments infrastructure on 10 Oct 2026, metric split into three measures, and the pass bar judged only at five audits.
Discovery document	**In progress**	Problem, subject, market scan, evidence register, advice received and changes made, pilot plan, business model and research gaps written. Survey responses and one expert interview are in; interviews with target-segment marketing leads are still to come.
MVP plan	**Done**	21 days, 3 weeks, 6 gates with arithmetic pass bars.
Published tracker link	**Done**	Live at https://geo.tinkeryard.dev. It reads one data file, and this PDF is generated from the same file.
Validation log	**In progress**	10-question survey is live and responses arrive from the Google Form automatically. One interview is logged (an incubator CEO and serial entrepreneur, not a target-segment buyer). No audits yet.
Input-Process-Output card	**Done**	Manual audit card; software is a labelling aid verified against hand labels.
Verdict	**Provisional**	Continue validation. Do not build a product yet. Updated on Day 21.

PUBLISHED TRACKER	https://geo.tinkeryard.dev
NORTH STAR	By 2 April 2027, I can take any problem I have observed in a real person from a written spec to a verified, running LLM MVP in under one week, and I can explain every line of it.

DELIVERABLE

1 Observation

STATUS
Draft composite, not a real person's account. All names, figures and details are illustrative. It will be replaced after three interviews (gate G1).

Illustrative composite. It is 11:40 PM on a Thursday in Singapore. A Head of Marketing at a 180-person B2B payments company has a leadership review at 9 AM. Organic traffic to product pages is down 27% over two quarters, yet rankings in her SEO tool look flat. Last week the CEO forwarded a prospect's screenshot: asked ChatGPT for the best payment gateway for cross-border marketplaces in Southeast Asia, two competitors were named and her company was not. The CEO's question was one line: "Why aren't we in this?" She tests it herself across ChatGPT, Perplexity and Gemini and gets a different answer every time. After 90 minutes she has 14 screenshots, no number and no baseline. Her agency's monthly report covers keywords and backlinks. Her leadership slide says "AI search impact: under investigation" for the third month running.

WHAT BREAKS	No repeatable measurement, no comparison with competitors, no link from any finding to an action.
COST TODAY	Assumed 3 to 4 hours a month of manual prompting and screenshots (untested; see the evidence register), plus a leadership question she cannot answer.

Who this is about

SUBJECT	Head of Marketing, Growth Lead or Marketing Manager who owns organic acquisition at a B2B payments infrastructure company (payment gateway, subscription billing, payouts or orchestration) of 50 to 500 staff in Singapore or Southeast Asia.
CONTEXT	Reports monthly to a CEO, already uses an SEO tool and often an agency, has tried typing prompts into ChatGPT by hand, and controls a tool budget of a few hundred Singapore dollars a month without procurement.
NOT THE USER (YET)	Large enterprises with dedicated SEO teams, and agencies. Adjacent B2B software and fintech companies come later and are logged as a separate segment. E-commerce and travel are later markets, not started.

DELIVERABLE

2 Hypothesis

Marketing leads at B2B payments infrastructure companies (payment gateways, subscription billing, payouts and orchestration) in Singapore and SEA who have seen organic traffic decline cannot report or improve their brand's presence in AI-generated answers, because no trusted, repeatable measurement exists in their workflow. If we deliver a hand-run AI Visibility Audit (30 buyer prompts, 4 AI engines, 3 runs each, three separate measures against 3 named competitors: recommendation rate (answers that offer the brand as a suitable option), citation rate (answers that link the brand's own domain as a source) and factual accuracy (whether the answers describe the brand correctly). Citation Share, the share of answers that cite or recommend the brand, is kept only as a secondary figure, 5 prioritised fixes) to real companies by 23 October 2026, then at least 3 of 5 will use it in an internal or leadership report and commit to paying S$300 a month for a recurring re-run.

ORIGINAL PASS BAR	3 of 5 by 9 Oct 2026
CURRENT PASS BAR	2 audits delivered and 3 real conversations by 23 Oct 2026, with a go/no-go on the remaining companies. The 3-of-5 commitment bar is judged only when five companies have been audited; before that the result is reported as 'x of N asked', with N stated.

What would prove us wrong

1. Fewer than 3 of 5 commit to a paid re-run.
2. Most say an existing tool already does this well enough.
3. They value it but say their agency should buy it: a different buyer, so discovery restarts.
4. Buyers value a one-off audit but do not renew, which would point to a quarterly or implementation service instead.
5. The number is unstable: Citation Share moves by more than 15 points across 3 runs in one week with no content changes.

Decision criteria

- Three paid follow-on commitments out of five is the first go or no-go signal, supported by actual payment where possible. It is judged only when five companies have been audited.
- Clients have implemented useful changes, with the page and date recorded.
- Delivery cost, logged by activity, supports the price.
- If buyers value a one-off audit but do not renew, test a quarterly or implementation service. If agencies hold the budget, test the agency as the buyer. If an existing tool already satisfies the need, revise the offer before building more software.
- This is an early signal, not proof of product-market fit.

Commitment, defined

Working definition: a commitment is a written yes (message or email) to pay S$300 a month for the re-run after seeing the audit. A verbal 'sounds good' does not count.

Pass-bar change log

- 3 Oct 2026: original bar set as 3 of 5 companies by 9 Oct 2026.
- 9 Oct 2026: re-dated to 23 Oct 2026. Five hand-run audits is about 1,800 answers (5 x 360) and no company had been confirmed, so the 9 Oct date was not reachable. An interim bar was added: 2 audits delivered and 3 real conversations, with a go or no-go on the rest.
- No result was changed to make the bar pass. The commitment bar of 3 of 5 is unchanged for the full pilot.
- 10 Oct 2026: after written advice from an expert advisor, the first segment was narrowed to B2B payments infrastructure in Singapore and Southeast Asia, and the metric was split into three separate measures. The 3-of-5 bar is unchanged.

DELIVERABLE

3 Discovery document

Look at actual past behaviour, not opinions: what triggered the question, what the person did, how long it took, how they reported it, and what happened next. Two tools: a 10-question screener survey to find the right people, then 20-minute interviews in the Mom Test style (questions about past behaviour, never about the idea) with strong leads.

Evidence base at a glance

SOURCE	REAL OR NOT	USED FOR
Founder's notes and hypothesis draft	Own reasoning, not evidence	Starting hypothesis and prompt set design
Composite observation	Not real	Placeholder until three interviews replace it
Friends survey (10 questions)	Real when answered; 0 responses so far	Find the right people to interview; not proof of willingness to pay
Mom Test interviews	Real when held; 0 so far	Observation, trigger event, current process, S$300 question
Golden set (5 labelling pairs, 1 rejected label)	Synthetic	Test the answer labeller before real answers exist
Published research and vendor statistics	Secondary, not re-checked	Context for why now; never promised to a client
Gemini-written research gaps	Hypothesis, unsourced	Small add-ons only
Written advice from an expert advisor	Real, but opinion	First segment and pilot design; not evidence of demand

Evidence register

Every number used, where it came from, and how far to trust it.

CLAIM	SOURCE	TYPE	HOW IT IS USED
Content changes raised measured visibility by up to about 40% in a 2023 benchmark	Aggarwal et al., GEO: Generative Engine Optimization, arXiv:2311.09735 (Princeton, Georgia Tech, Allen Institute for AI, IIT Delhi), GEO-bench	Academic paper and benchmark (arXiv preprint)	Evidence for the category, not for a client, and not tested on current engines. Never quoted in client material.
38% fewer organic clicks when a Google AI Overview appears	Randomised field study, ISB and Carnegie Mellon, Apr 2026 (as cited in the founder's pitch decks)	Secondary, not re-checked	Why-now context only.
About 2.2x clicks per impression for brands cited in a Google AI Overview, in one 53-brand study	Seer Interactive, 53 brands, Apr 2026 (as cited in the founder's pitch decks)	Secondary, vendor study	Why-now context only. An association, not evidence that being cited causes clicks.

CLAIM	SOURCE	TYPE	HOW IT IS USED
38% of B2B buyers use generative AI to evaluate and shortlist vendors	Responsive, Inside the Buyer's Mind (as cited in the founder's pitch decks)	Second-hand, no longer used	Replaced in the decks by the checked G2 figure.
900 million people use ChatGPT weekly	OpenAI, Feb 2026 (as cited in the founder's pitch decks)	Secondary, company statement	Scale context only.
Competitor funding and prices (Profound, Peec AI, Semrush and others)	Dealroom 15 Sep 2026; Surmado tool comparison May 2026 (as cited in the founder's investor deck)	Secondary	Tests falsifier 2: is an existing tool enough?
Manual checking costs 3 to 4 hours a month	Hypothesis. Tested by survey Q6 and by interviews.	Unverified assumption	Replace with interview data.
Organic traffic down 27% over two quarters; CEO forwards a screenshot	Draft composite observation	Not real evidence yet	Replace with a real person's numbers.
Three GEO gaps: attribution, third-party sources, crawl and context	Gemini-written report with unsourced statistics	Hypothesis	Shapes small add-ons only. Not used in sales copy.
51% of surveyed B2B software buyers start software research with an AI chatbot more often than Google, and 71% use chatbots somewhere in research (1,076 buyers, March 2026)	G2, The Answer Economy, April 2026. Checked against G2's page on 10 Oct 2026.	Secondary vendor survey, checked	Why-now context. Not specific to SEA payments buyers.
AI-referred retail visits converted at a rate 60% higher than non-AI visits (US retail analytics, July 2026)	Adobe AI Traffic Trends Report, Aug 2026, as cited by the advisor. Confirmed through press coverage of Adobe; the report itself could not be opened.	Secondary, observational, not checked at source	Why-now context. An observed channel comparison, not a forecast for any client.
AI-referred traffic to US travel sites grew 119% year on year in July 2026, and AI-referred conversion was 1% lower than non-AI (47% lower a year earlier)	Adobe, as cited by the advisor and reported by press coverage; Adobe's page could not be opened.	Secondary, not checked at source	Context for the travel market only. US data, not SEA.
Shopify gives merchants access to major AI shopping channels, with native performance tracking and product data recommendations	Shopify announcement (24 Mar 2026) and changelog (11 May 2026), checked on 10 Oct 2026.	Vendor documentation, checked	Competition note for the e-commerce market: native features exist, so a gap must be shown first.
Google says its AI search features rely on foundational SEO and need no special AI markup or AI text files	Google Search Central, updated July 2026, checked on 10 Oct 2026. Applies to Google Search only.	Vendor guidance, checked	Limits what the audit can claim about formatting and llms.txt.
Industry ranking, pilot sequence and adoption assessments	Written recommendation from an expert advisor, 10 Oct 2026	Expert opinion, not measured	Shapes the first segment and the pilot design. Not evidence of demand.

Market scan

PLAYER	SIGNAL	BUILT FOR
Profound	Reported US$180M Series D at a US$1.8B valuation (Sep 2026; per Dealroom, as cited in the founder's investor deck; not re-checked)	Enterprise, Fortune 500
Peec AI	Reported US$29M raised (as cited in the founder's investor deck; not re-checked)	Mid-market brand teams
Semrush, Ahrefs, HubSpot	AI-visibility add-ons from roughly US$50 to 199 a month	Existing SEO and CRM users
Otterly, Rankscale	Self-serve trackers from roughly US$20 to 29 a month	Solo marketers, agencies

Vendor funding and price lists suggest buyers already pay for AI visibility, and dashboards are abundant. The bet is not another dashboard but a number a mid-market marketing lead in SEA can defend to a CEO, with fixes attached. Falsifier 2 (an existing tool is enough) is therefore the greatest risk.

Research gaps and where they fit the MVP

GAP	WHAT IT IS	FIT WITH THE MVP
Attribution	Answers resolved inside the AI interface leave no click for Google Analytics 4 (GA4) to see, so leadership cannot see AI's influence.	Partly in scope: a self-reported 'where did you first hear about us' field. GA4 referral setup and econometrics are out.
Third-party sources	Engines may cite review sites and forums rather than a brand's own pages, so stale outside data shapes what AI says about the brand.	In scope and cheap: tally own, competitor and third-party sources per answer. Factual accuracy (Accurate, Outdated, Wrong, checked against the client's own fact sheet) is now one of the three core measures.
Crawl and context	AI crawlers may skip JavaScript and truncate heavy pages (unverified; from an unsourced report, to be tested on known sites). Literal translation can lose the brand in other languages.	Crawler check is in scope as a diagnostic only (robots.txt, raw-HTML content, JSON-LD and llms.txt present or absent). It reports what is there and does not claim any of it improves AI visibility. Google's guidance says no special AI markup or llms.txt is needed, so neither is recommended as a fix. Multilingual is out for v1.

The source for these gaps is a Gemini-written report with unsourced statistics. They are treated as hypotheses, not facts, and are not used in sales copy.

Advice received and what changed

An expert advisor, a founder and serial entrepreneur in the startup ecosystem (the interviewee logged in the validation log). 10 October 2026. Written recommendation sent after the interview.

Expert opinion. The industry ranking, pilot sequence and adoption assessments are recommendations, not measured probabilities, and the document claims no statistical probability of adoption. It does not show that anyone will pay.

RECOMMENDATION	DECISION	WHAT CHANGED
Start with one industry: B2B payments infrastructure in Singapore and SEA	**Adopted**	The subject and hypothesis now name B2B payments infrastructure. Adjacent software and fintech come later and are logged separately.
Report recommendation rate, citation rate and factual accuracy separately	**Adopted**	The input, process and output card, the label rule and the audit toolkit now use three measures. Citation Share stays as a secondary figure.
Keep a fixed core question set, and log prompt, engine, mode, date, geography, method and raw answer	**Adopted**	Written into the method and into a run-log template in the audit repo. The report must say whether answers came from consumer interfaces or APIs.

RECOMMENDATION	DECISION	WHAT CHANGED
Run a 6 to 8 week pilot: interviews, baseline, implementation, rerun	**Adapted**	The 21-day plan covers roughly weeks 1 to 3 of that pilot. The rerun and the request for a paid renewal fall after 23 October.
Three paid follow-on commitments of five, plus implemented changes and delivery cost	**Adapted**	The 3-of-5 bar is kept and judged only at five audits. Two gates were added: implemented changes (G7) and unit economics (G8).
Treat S$300 a month as a hypothesis and log time and cost	**Adopted**	Gate G8 and the unit-economics table. Figures shown are calculations, not observed costs.
Build in this order: method and question library, collection and logs, labelling with human review, recurring monitoring after renewals	**Partly adopted**	Recorded as the build order. The day-by-day plan still builds tools from Day 8, before any audit is delivered; whether to hold that back is a decision for the founder.
Keep claims practical: no 'SEO is ending', no 'SEO tools are blind', no formatting or llms.txt guarantees	**Adopted**	The 'will not claim' list is extended, and the crawler check is described as a diagnostic only.
Interview 8 to 10 marketing leaders and offer five scoped audits	**Noted**	Kept as the pilot target. Gate G1 stays at three target-segment conversations.
E-commerce and travel as later markets	**Not started**	Recorded with the advisor's expansion conditions. They need product-level data or a hospitality partner, and are outside this MVP.
Keep claims practical in client material (no 'what moves the number', no schema or llms.txt levers, no research percentages as promises)	**Adopted**	Both decks were revised on 10 Oct 2026. See 'Deck revisions' below.

Sources cited in the advisor's document were checked on 10 October 2026. The G2, Shopify and Google statements match their pages. Adobe's pages could not be opened, so its figures are marked as reported by press coverage. A figure of 42% of consumers using AI assistants for shopping could not be confirmed (independent sources point to a different number) and is not used.

Deck revisions

10 October 2026. The industry and investor decks were reviewed against the advisor's guidance on practical claims and against Google's published guidance, then revised. The editable sources and regenerated PDFs are in the audit repository.

- The slide titled 'What moves the number' is now 'What we check and recommend'. Schema markup, llms.txt and the 'up to 40%' research figure no longer appear on client-facing slides; the research is cited as background only.
- 'The blind spot' is now 'What a rank report does not show', and 'What decides the AI answer' is now 'What an AI-answer check adds', so the deck no longer implies that a rank report cannot see the problem.
- Citation Share is no longer the headline. The decks report recommendation rate, citation rate and factual accuracy separately, with cited-or-recommended as a secondary figure.
- The unverified '38% of B2B buyers' statistic was replaced by the checked G2 figure (51% of 1,076 surveyed B2B software buyers). Second-hand statistics are marked 'not re-checked', and the 2.2x click figure is described as an association, not proof of cause.
- Illustrative examples and the composite scenario are labelled as illustrative on the same slide, and funding figures are marked as reported, not re-checked.
- The segment is now B2B payments infrastructure. The investor deck's validation slide shows 0 of 5 audits delivered at 10 October 2026, with the 3-of-5 bar judged at five audits.
- Still to fill in by the founder: contact details, the mentor line and the funding ask. The PPTX files were edited in place and have not been visually checked; the PDFs were.

Industry focus

Established payment gateways, subscription billing platforms, payout providers and payment orchestration companies in Singapore and SEA, with customer evidence, a marketing owner, an acquisition budget and the ability to update their website.

RANK	INDUSTRY AND STARTING SEGMENT	ASSESSMENT
1	B2B software: payments infrastructure in Singapore and SEA	Strongest fit for the current audit and the founder's payments experience. Start here.
2	E-commerce: established brands selling products buyers compare	Strong commercial potential, but needs product-level data and catalogue capabilities. Enter once the core audit is validated and customers need product-level diagnosis. Shopify already offers native AI-channel tracking, so a gap must be shown first.
3	Travel and hospitality: boutique hotel groups, resorts, specialist operators	Clear discovery use cases, but local demand is untested and results are affected by seasonality and booking platforms. Test after the first software segment, ideally through a hospitality partner.

The ranking and the adoption assessments are the advisor's recommendations, not measured probabilities. Paid demand in India and Southeast Asia still needs validation.

Pilot plan

Advisor-proposed pilot of 6 to 8 weeks for one payments segment. It is a planning window, not a promise of visibility improvement or revenue. Procurement, client implementation and indexing may extend it. The 21-day plan covers roughly the first three weeks.

WHEN	ACTIVITY	OUTPUT
Weeks 1 and 2	Interview 8 to 10 relevant marketing leaders and offer five scoped audits. Ask what current tools miss.	Confirm the buyer, urgency, budget and implementation owner.
Weeks 2 and 3	Run the agreed buyer questions and assess answers, competitors and factual accuracy.	A documented baseline and five prioritised changes.
Weeks 3 to 5	Support client implementation and record what changed and when.	Confirm the recommendations are useful and feasible.
Weeks 5 to 8	Repeat measurement under the same conditions and request the next paid cycle.	Assess variation, customer value, delivery cost and renewal.

Measurement rules

- Report recommendation rate, citation rate and factual accuracy separately. A combined score can hide whether AI actually recommends the business, so Citation Share (cited or recommended) is kept only as a secondary figure.
- Record for every answer: the prompt, engine, mode (consumer interface or API), date, geography, collection method and the raw answer.
- Keep a fixed core question set. New wording or extra questions are a separate exploratory test and never mix into core figures.
- Use repeated runs and, where practical, a comparison group. Do not attribute all movement to client changes: engines and competitor content also change.
- Keep visibility, referral traffic and commercial outcomes distinct. A sampled inclusion rate is not market share.
- Report variation as a range across runs, with the number of answers behind each figure.

Unit economics, calculated

CALCULATION	RESULT
5 clients at S$300 a month	S$1,500 a month
One full cycle per client: 30 prompts x 4 engines x 3 runs	360 answers (120 per pass)
Brand assessments per cycle: the client plus 3 competitors	up to 1,440 (360 x 4)
Five clients, one full cycle each	1,800 answers and up to 7,200 brand assessments
Revenue per answer at S$300 per 360-answer cycle	about S$0.83, before any labour

These are calculations from the proposed workflow, not observed costs. The price stays a hypothesis until paid customers and logged delivery costs validate it: minutes by activity (collection, review, diagnosis, report, call) plus engine and infrastructure cost. Google AI Overviews has no API, so API runs cover three engines (270 answers per cycle).

Build order

WHEN	BUILD OR IMPROVE	WHY
First	Documented audit method and a payments question library	Prove useful diagnosis and repeatable delivery.
Next	Answer collection, evidence logs and report automation	Reduce work already demonstrated by hand.
Then	Reliable labelling with human review of disputed cases	Increase capacity while keeping measurement quality.
After renewals	Recurring monitoring and a client workflow	Build around demonstrated recurring demand.
After segment proof	Adjacent software, then selected commerce or travel pilots	Expand with evidence and the right capabilities.

Business model

STAGE	WHAT
Now: pilot	Hand-run audit for one company: one report, one readout call. Proves the value by hand.
Next: under test	S$300 a month recurring re-run of the same prompt set. The price is a hypothesis: for each audit, minutes by activity and engine cost are logged, and the price stays only if the delivery cost leaves an acceptable margin.
Later: planned, not validated	SaaS tiers. Base US$199 to 299 a month (one brand, about 50 prompts). Agency US$1,000 to 2,500+ a month (multi-brand).

Roadmap: automate only what is done by hand

PHASE	WHAT
Phase 0 (now)	Documented method, payments question library and hand-run audits for up to five companies in one category. Decide go or no-go.
Phase 1	Answer collection, evidence logs and report automation, for work already done by hand.
Phase 2	Reliable labelling with human review of disputed cases. Ships only when it matches the golden set at 90% or better.
Phase 3 (after renewals)	Recurring monitoring and a client workflow.
Phase 4 (after segment proof)	Adjacent software, then selected e-commerce or travel pilots.

Pilot offer

THE CLIENT GIVES	THE CLIENT GETS
• Your brand and 3 competitors • 30 minutes with sales to draft prompts • 30 minutes for the readout call	• Citation Share against 3 competitors • 5 page-level fixes • The full answer log • A stability re-run of 5 prompts (inside the 21 days for the first clients, the following week for later ones)

What we will not claim

- No guaranteed uplift. We measure and recommend; the engines decide.
- No claim beyond a one-week snapshot. Engines change on their own, so every row is dated.
- Stability is tested: 5 prompts re-run a week later, and a score that moves more than 15 points is reported as unstable.
- A person confirms every label. Software may pre-label.
- Logged-out answers only. Personalised answers can differ.
- We refer the client to an existing tool if it already covers the need.
- No claim that organic traffic is ending, or that existing SEO tools cannot see AI answers. SEO fundamentals still matter, and many SEO suites now add AI-visibility modules.
- No claim that a format, schema markup or an llms.txt file makes an engine recommend a brand. Google's guidance says its AI features rely on standard SEO. The crawler check reports what is present and is a diagnostic, not a remedy.
- No quoting of research gains such as 'up to 40%' in client material. It is a best case from a 2023 benchmark, not a forecast for any client.
- Citation Share is a sampled inclusion rate for a chosen prompt set, engine, date and location. It is not market share or share of voice, and it is shown with its sample size and date.
- Movement after a fix is reported as observed and never attributed in full to the fix, because engines and competitors also change.
- Recommendations rest on what cited competitor pages contain. They are not guaranteed to change what any engine returns.

DELIVERABLE

4 21-day manual MVP plan

Manual-first: every audit is hand-run and hand-labelled. Software is only a labelling aid, and it ships only if it matches hand labels on a held-out set at 90% or better.

> **WHY THIS IS A MANUAL MVP**
> The core test is manual: can one person deliver the audit by hand, and will companies commit to paying for it? That needs no software, and the smallest version is a spreadsheet with hand-labelled answers. The advisor's build order is the method and a payments question library first, then collection and logs, then a labelling aid with human review, then recurring monitoring only after renewals. The day-by-day plan below builds labelling tools from Day 8, before any audit is delivered; whether to hold that back until the first hand-run audit and the S$300 question is the founder's decision.

Success gates

GATE	PASS BAR	CURRENT
G1 Real user	Observation rewritten from 3 real conversations	1 of 3 conversations logged, with an incubator CEO who is not a target-segment buyer. The plan's Day 5 target of 3 conversations was missed. Survey responses are not interviews.
G2 Labeller accuracy	90% or better agreement with golden labels on a held-out set of 30 answers, every label quoted	Dev set: 5 of 6 (83%) with the hosted model. The 5 labelling pairs are synthetic, so this is a prototype check, not evidence of accuracy. Held-out set not built yet.
G3 Stability	Citation Share drifts no more than 15 points across 3 runs in one week	Not measured yet
G4 Known-answer test	Audit reproduces a known result: a prompt whose answer is already known from the real client's own test (the composite's CEO-screenshot prompt is a placeholder)	Not run yet
G5 Shipped	App produces the log and one-page report; 2 audits delivered on it	0 audits delivered. Gradio app not built yet (plan day 15).
G6 Willingness to pay	A written yes to S$300 a month from companies that received an audit, reported as x of N delivered, with first actual payments reported separately as the stronger signal. 3 of 5 is judged only when five companies have been audited.	0 of 0
G7 Implemented changes	At least 2 audited companies implement at least 1 of the 5 changes, with the page and date recorded	Not started
G8 Unit economics	Minutes per audit logged by activity, plus engine cost. A minimum acceptable margin is stated before the first audit, and S$300 is kept only if the logged cost leaves that margin	Not started

Day by day

DAY	DATE	ACTIVITY	STATUS
1	3 Oct	Re-date hypothesis; list 15 reachable marketing leads; send 10 outreach messages Planned output: List of 15 named people, 10 sent Evidence: Survey form built as the outreach vehicle. Outreach count not recorded. Note: created the survey and sent	In progress
2	4 Oct	Pick client #1; collect brand, aliases, 3 competitors, domains Planned output: entities.json for client #1	In progress
3	5 Oct	Mom Test conversations #1 and #2 Planned output: 2 interview notes	To do Behind plan
4	6 Oct	Conversation #3; rewrite the observation with a real person Planned output: Observation replaced, no composite	In progress
5	7 Oct	Draft the 30 buyer prompts in buyer language Planned output: prompts.csv, 30 rows	To do Behind plan
6	8 Oct	Hand-run slice: 10 prompts x 2 engines x 3 runs Planned output: 60 raw answers logged	To do Behind plan
7	9 Oct	Label all 60 by hand; list every ruling; send label rule to mentor Planned output: 60 labelled rows and rulings list	To do Behind plan

DAY	DATE	ACTIVITY	STATUS
8	10 Oct	Golden set as code and eval.py Planned output: eval.py scores any labeller Evidence: Built early: eval.py, golden/labels.jsonl, 9 passing unit tests.	**Done**
9	11 Oct	Runner: call engine APIs, log raw answers with timestamp and model id Planned output: 10 prompts x 3 engines logged automatically	**To do**
10	12 Oct	Deterministic labeller: own domain, alias match, empty answers Planned output: Matches hand labels on rule cases Evidence: labellers/rules.py scores 2 of 6 on the golden dev set; Recommended vs Mentioned left to the model.	**In progress**
11	13 Oct	LLM labeller for Recommended vs Mentioned with quoted evidence Planned output: First G2 score Evidence: Hosted Hugging Face labeller built. 5 of 6 (83%) on dev set, below the 90% bar.	**In progress**
12	14 Oct	Iterate on the dev set only; add disputed labels as golden pairs Planned output: Dev agreement 85% or better	**To do**
13	15 Oct	Citation Share calculator checked against hand numbers Planned output: Code number equals hand number	**To do**
14	16 Oct	G2 test on the held-out 30 Planned output: Held-out agreement recorded	**To do**
15	17 Oct	Gradio UI: inputs to labelled table to Citation Share Planned output: App runs end to end on client #1	**To do**
16	18 Oct	One-page report with source tally and footer dates Planned output: Report exports as PDF or HTML	**To do**
17	19 Oct	Crawler check: robots.txt, raw-HTML content, llms.txt, JSON-LD Planned output: Matches a site with a known answer	**To do**
18	20 Oct	Full run on client #1: 30 prompts x 3 engines x 3 runs (270 answers); known-answer test; drift Planned output: G3 and G4 written down	**To do**
19	21 Oct	Write 5 fixes; deliver audit #1 on a call; ask the S$300 question Planned output: Answer recorded verbatim	**To do**
20	22 Oct	Audit #2 on a second company; re-run 5 prompts from audit #1 Planned output: 2 audits delivered; early stability read (a full one-week re-run falls after Day 21)	**To do**
21	23 Oct	Verdict day: fill the gates, write go/no-go, recall test Planned output: Dated verdict	**To do**

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5 Published tracker link

https://geo.tinkeryard.dev

The tracker is the execution layer, not proof of validation. It shows the 21-day plan as a kanban board, the validation log, the evidence register and the verdict. Edits are made on the site behind an edit key, and this PDF is rebuilt from the saved board, so the two cannot drift apart.

- Board: each day is a card. A card can move to Done only when it carries evidence.
- Validation tab: survey responses, interviews and audits are logged by role and company type, not by name.
- Method tab: the input, process and output card and the golden set.

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6 Validation log

Screener to find the right people. It does not validate willingness to pay.

Strong lead: Q1 is A or B, Q2 is A, Q4 is A or B, and Q10 is B (approved a S$100 to S$500 a month tool without procurement).

SURVEY RESPONSES	8
IN THE TARGET SEGMENT	0 of 8 (Q1 A or B and Q2 A)
STRONG LEADS	0
REAL CONVERSATIONS	1 of 3 target
AUDITS DELIVERED	0
SURVEY FORM	Open the survey form

What the responses say so far

Counts per answer. This is a small group of friends and contacts, so it is a screener, not evidence of demand.

#	QUESTION	ANSWERS
1	Which best describes your work?	Marketing, growth or SEO at a company: 1 Founder or owner: 1 Sales or business development: 2 Product or engineering: 1 Agency or consultant: 2 Something else: 1
2	What kind of organisation do you work in?	B2B software or fintech: 1 Another kind of B2B company: 3 Consumer brand: 1 Agency: 2 I don't work at a company: 1
3	In the last 30 days, how often did you use ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini or a similar tool to research a product, tool or vendor?	Once or twice: 1 About weekly: 1 Several times a week: 3 Daily: 3
4	Has anyone from leadership (boss, client, investor, customer) asked whether your Brand/Product shows up in AI answers?	Yes, more than once: 1 Yes, once: 1 No, but I wondered myself: 3 No, never: 1 Not applicable to me: 2

#	QUESTION	ANSWERS
5	What did you do when the search results didn't showed up your brand/product?	Reframed the question into an AI tool myself: 4 Asked an agency or a colleague: 1 Used a paid tool: 2 No answer recorded: 1
6	How often you are searching your brand/product to show up in the AI results?	None: 4 Under 1 hour: 2 1 to 3 hours: 1 More than 3 hours: 1
7	How do you report on AI search to leadership today?	I don't: 2 Screenshots or anecdotes: 2 A spreadsheet I keep: 1 My agency reports it: 1 A tool dashboard: 2
8	If you had a number showing how often AI engines recommend your brand/product against the competitors, what would you most likely do with it?	Put it in a leadership report: 3 Decide where to spend content effort: 1 Justify or defend budget: 2 Not sure: 2
9	What would stop you trusting that number?	It changes every time it is run: 1 I don't know how it was measured: 3 It can't be tied to traffic or revenue: 2 I'd want a person to check the labels: 1 Nothing, I'd trust it: 1
10	Think of the last software tool you started for your team or company. What was its monthly cost, and who had to approve it?	Nothing, it needs approval, Approved myself: 1 S$100 to S$500 a month, approved myself: 5 S$500 to S$1000 a month, needed review: 1 S$100 to S$300 a month (wording from an earlier version of this question): 1 From the form summary chart, 10 October 2026. Not matched to individual respondents.

Known gaps in the survey

- Q5 offers three options and no 'nothing' answer, so people who did nothing cannot answer it accurately.
- Q6 asks 'how often' but its options mix time spent and frequency (None, Under 1 hour, 1 to 3 hours, More than 3 hours, Once in 24 hrs), so it is read as a rough signal only.
- Q10 option A reads 'Nothing, it needs approval, Approved myself', which contradicts itself.
- Responses are from friends and contacts, not a sample of the subject.
- Q10 answers are not yet matched to individual respondents, so the per-respondent table shows Q10 blank. Its counts come from the form's own summary chart. One respondent chose an option from an earlier version of the question.

Survey questions

#	QUESTION	OPTIONS	WHAT IT TESTS
1	Which best describes your work?	A. Marketing, growth or SEO at a company · B. Founder or owner · C. Sales or business development · D. Product or engineering · E. Agency or consultant · F. Something else	Is this the subject or a different segment
2	What kind of organisation do you work in?	A. B2B software or fintech · B. Another kind of B2B company · C. Consumer brand · D. Agency · E. I don't work at a company	Segment fit (B2B SaaS and fintech, 50–500 staff)

#	QUESTION	OPTIONS	WHAT IT TESTS
3	In the last 30 days, how often did you use ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini or a similar tool to research a product, tool or vendor?	A. Not at all · B. Once or twice · C. About weekly · D. Several times a week · E. Daily	Whether buyers really research this way (past behaviour)
4	Has anyone from leadership (boss, client, investor, customer) asked whether your Brand/Product shows up in AI answers?	A. Yes, more than once · B. Yes, once · C. No, but I wondered myself · D. No, never · E. Not applicable to me	Is there a real trigger (the CEO-screenshot moment)
5	What did you do when the search results didn't showed up your brand/product?	A. Reframed the question into an AI tool myself · B. Asked an agency or a colleague · C. Used a paid tool	Current process and bottleneck. Only 3 options: people who did nothing have no matching answer
6	How often you are searching your brand/product to show up in the AI results?	A. None · B. Under 1 hour · C. 1 to 3 hours · D. More than 3 hours · E. Once in 24 hrs	How often they check by hand (the hypothesis says 3 to 4 hours a month). Options mix frequency and time spent, so read with care
7	How do you report on AI search to leadership today?	A. I don't · B. Screenshots or anecdotes · C. A spreadsheet I keep · D. My agency reports it · E. A tool dashboard	Falsifiers 2 and 3: tool already exists, or agency is the buyer
8	If you had a number showing how often AI engines recommend your brand/product against the competitors, what would you most likely do with it?	A. Put it in a leadership report · B. Decide where to spend content effort · C. Justify or defend budget · D. Probably not use it · E. Not sure	Decision the output enables
9	What would stop you trusting that number?	A. It changes every time it is run · B. I don't know how it was measured · C. It can't be tied to traffic or revenue · D. I'd want a person to check the labels · E. Nothing, I'd trust it	Falsifier 4 (stability) and the labelling rule
10	Think of the last software tool you started for your team or company. What was its monthly cost, and who had to approve it?	A. Nothing, it needs approval, Approved myself · B. S$100 to S$500 a month, approved myself · C. S$500 to S$1000 a month, needed review · D. More than S$1000 a month, needed approval	Budget authority without procurement, as a signal against the S$300 price

Only respondents with Q1 = marketing, growth or SEO (or founder or owner) and Q2 = B2B software or fintech count towards the subject. Everyone else is logged as a segment signal (agency, consumer brand, product or engineering), not toward the 3-of-5 bar. Q10 is a signal, not proof. The form was revised on 10 October 2026, so answers given before that date may use older wording; the tracker records the letter chosen.

Tally after 10 or more responses: share with Q4 = A or B, share with Q7 = B, share with Q10 = B, subject-fit respondents and strong leads. Strong leads get a 20-minute Mom Test interview.

Survey responses

RESPONDENT	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
F1	A	D	D	A		A	E	A	E	
F2	B	E	C	E	A	A	E	E	B	
F3	F	B	D	C	A	B	B	E	B	
F4	D	A	E	D	C	A	A	C	C	
F5	C	B	E	C	C	D	C	C	D	
F6	C	C	B	B	A	C	B	A	C	
F7	E	B	D	E	A	A	A	B	A	
F8	E	D	E	C	B	B	D	A	B	

Interview script

1. Walk me through the last time someone asked whether you show up in ChatGPT. What did you do, and how long did it take?
2. Which questions do your buyers ask when comparing payment providers? Have you tried any in an AI tool?
3. What do your current tools or agency miss, and what do you pay today for SEO or monitoring?
4. How did you report this last month, and to whom?
5. Who would approve S$300 a month, and who would make page changes? (Ask what they pay today before naming the price, and record any price they name in their own words.)
6. Would you pay S$300 a month for a re-run with 5 changes? If yes, can you confirm in writing this week?

Interviews

DATE	PERSON	TRIGGER IN THEIR WORDS	DID	REPORTED	S$300?	NOTES
Logged 10 Oct 2026 (interview date not recorded)	CEO of Incubz and serial entrepreneur (incubator and startup ecosystem; not a target-segment marketing lead)	Not recorded verbatim. Founder's notes: he said this is a current problem for every other company.	Not recorded	Not recorded	Not asked	He expects the engine to give recommendations after thorough research, which matches the 5 prioritised fixes in the report. This is his view of other companies, not his own past behaviour. Price, who would pay and how he reports are untested. Counts as conversation 1 of 3, with the segment caveat. He later sent a written recommendation (10 Oct 2026) on industry focus and a 6 to 8 week pilot; see the Discovery section.

Audits delivered

DATE	COMPANY TYPE	CITATION SHARE	USED IN A REPORT?	COMMITTED TO S$300?
No audits delivered yet.				

Limitations

- Survey responses so far come from friends and contacts and are a small sample. They are not a representative or random group.
- One interview is logged, with an incubator CEO and serial entrepreneur. He is an ecosystem expert rather than a marketing lead who would buy the audit, and his view is about other companies, so it supports the problem but does not test price or willingness to pay.
- No audits are logged yet, so the price and willingness to pay are untested.
- Friends and advisors answer politely; a stated opinion is weaker evidence than a signed re-run.
- The survey form was revised during collection (Q4, Q5, Q6, Q8, Q10), so some questions are not comparable across all responses.
- Small sample, no control group, no claim of causality or prevalence.

SUPPORTING METHOD

Golden set and grading

13 golden pairs (hand-written correct answers used to score the labeller) written before any software: 8 audit-scoping pairs (3 clean, 3 failure, 1 v2 segment, 1 no-audit-needed) and 5 answer-labelling pairs, plus 1 rejected label. In code: 5 labelling pairs plus 1 rejected case, scored by eval.py.

LABEL RULE	PLAN GRADING RULE (PASSES IF IT DOES ALL FIVE)
• Cited: the entity's own domain (or a subdomain) is linked as a source. • Recommended: offered as a suitable answer, by name or alias. • Mentioned: named without a link and not offered as an option, including negative mentions (flagged separately). • Absent: none of the above. • Recommendation rate = answers where the entity is Recommended / answers returned. Citation rate = answers where it is Cited / answers returned. Citation Share (cited or recommended) is a secondary figure. Empty answers are excluded. Every label quotes its evidence.	1. Matches the verdict. 2. Names the buying questions and ties the prompt set to real prospect language; no prompt contains the brand name. 3. Gives a metric with a baseline (or says this audit is the baseline) and includes the stability re-run. 4. Tests on at least one prompt where the answer is already known. 5. Lists what is out of scope.

Target: At least 90% agreement on a random sample of 30 answers, both between two human labellers and between the labeller and the golden labels.

- Disputed labels become new golden pairs.
- Stranger test: give the label rule and unlabelled answers to someone outside marketing; every question they ask is a ruling the rule still needs.
- The 5 labelling pairs in code are synthetic; replace them with real answers as audits run.
- Add an accuracy label (Accurate, Outdated, Wrong, Not checkable) checked against the client's own fact sheet, with golden examples built from real answers.

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7 Input, process, output card

INPUT	PROCESS	OUTPUT

• Brand name, domain, aliases and product names • 3 named competitors and their aliases • 30 core buyer prompts in the buyer's own words, with no brand names, taken from real sales or procurement questions in payments. The set is frozen once the first run starts; new wording or extra questions go in a separate exploratory set • Target market and language (for example Singapore, English) • Client website: robots.txt and key pages	1. Run each prompt on ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews, logged out, location Singapore, 3 runs each (30 x 4 x 3 = 360 answers). Google AI Overviews has no API, so API runs cover 3 engines (270 answers) and AI Overviews is added by hand or dropped 2. Log each answer with: prompt, question-set version, engine and version, mode (consumer interface or API), logged out or in, geography, collection method, run number, date, raw answer, listed sources and who labelled it 3. Label each brand per answer: Cited, Recommended, Mentioned or Absent, with a quoted justification 4. Compute three separate measures per engine and per brand: recommendation rate, citation rate and factual accuracy. Cited-or-recommended (Citation Share) is kept as a secondary figure with its four-way split, and every figure shows how many answers sit behind it 5. Check the site: crawler access, schema, headings, definition-first pages 6. Compare cited competitor pages with the client's pages 7. Re-run 5 prompts to test stability (a week later where the calendar allows)	• One-page AI Visibility Report: recommendation rate, citation rate and factual accuracy per engine against 3 competitors, with the number of answers and the variation across runs • The 5 prompts where competitors win and the client is absent • 5 prioritised changes, each with a page or external source, an owner and the evidence behind it • The raw answer log • Decision enabled: where to spend next month's content effort, and a defensible answer to 'Are we showing up in AI search?'

The AI labeller is an aid, not the product. It ships only if it matches hand labels on a held-out set at 90% or better, and a human confirms every label.

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8 Verdict

CONTINUE VALIDATION. DO NOT BUILD A PRODUCT YET.

The problem is plausible and the hypothesis is testable. Early survey responses and one expert interview support that the problem is real, and the expert's written advice sharpened the first segment and the pilot. But the interviewee is not a target-segment buyer, no audits are logged, the observation is still a composite, and nothing yet shows that anyone in the target segment will pay.

As of 10 October 2026

Decision rules

CALL	WHEN
Proceed	Gates G1 to G5 pass, at least 3 of 5 audited companies give a written S$300 re-run commitment (actual payment where possible), clients implemented useful changes, and delivery cost supports the price. Judged only when five companies have been audited. An early signal, not proof of product-market fit.
Pivot	The problem is real but the budget sits with an agency (test the agency as the buyer), or buyers value a one-off audit but do not renew (test a quarterly or implementation service), or an existing tool is judged good enough (revise the offer), or the number is unstable.
Stop	Fewer than 3 real people can name a time leadership asked them about AI search, or nobody will pay.

By dimension

DIMENSION	VERDICT
Observation	Starting signal only. Composite, to be replaced.
Segment focus	Narrowed to B2B payments infrastructure in SG and SEA on expert advice. The advice is opinion and the segment is untested.
Problem	Plausible, not validated.
Metric (Citation Share)	Defined and testable. Stability unproven.
Labelling	Prototype scored 5 of 6 on a synthetic dev set. Not trustworthy yet.
Willingness to pay	Unknown.
Product	Do not build yet.

Next action

Hold interviews with marketing leads at B2B payments companies (the advisor suggests 8 to 10 for the pilot; gate G1 needs 3), replace the observation, and define the baseline report. Build the wider platform only after audits prove useful, customers pay again and the unit economics support it.

Submission summary

- Observation: a draft composite, to be replaced by real interviews (gate G1).
- Discovery: a defined subject, narrowed to B2B payments infrastructure on expert advice, an evidence register that separates real from secondary and synthetic sources, and three small research-gap add-ons.
- MVP: a manual 21-day audit, with software limited to labelling aids that must beat 90% on a held-out set.
- Validation: the 10-question survey is live and collecting responses, and one expert interview is logged. No audits are logged yet.
- Verdict: continue validation. Do not build a product yet.